

Sick Leave Policy

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The Sick Leave Policy outlines the procedures, eligibility criteria, and responsibilities associated with taking leave due to illness or injury. This policy complies with Lebanese Labour Law and aims to support employee health while ensuring minimal disruption to business operations.

1. Eligibility Criteria:

Employees who are unable to perform their work duties due to physical or mental illness or injury are eligible for sick leave. To qualify for paid sick leave, employees must meet the following conditions:

- Be a full-time employee of inmind.ai with a valid employment contract.
- Have completed at least three months of continuous service with the company.
- Submit a valid medical certificate within the required timeframe (described below).

Part-time and probationary employees may also request sick leave; however, their entitlement to paid sick leave will be assessed on a case-by-case basis and according to applicable Lebanese Labour Law.

2. Sick Leave Entitlements:

In compliance with Lebanese Labour Law, employees are entitled to up to 15 days of paid sick leave per calendar year, provided they submit valid medical documentation. The following terms apply:

- Paid sick leave is calculated based on the employee's most recent salary.
- Sick leave balances reset at the beginning of each calendar year and cannot be carried forward.
- Sick leave beyond the 15-day annual allowance may be granted as unpaid leave or additional paid leave at the discretion of management and on a case-by-case basis.

3. Notification Procedures:

Employees who are unable to report to work due to illness or injury must adhere to the following notification procedures:

- Notify the direct supervisor as soon as possible, preferably within one hour of the start of the workday.
- Provide an estimate of the expected duration of the absence.
- If the absence extends beyond three consecutive days, submit a valid medical certificate from a licensed healthcare provider.
- In cases of sudden illness or emergency, employees may designate a family member or representative to notify the company on their behalf.

4. Documentation Requirements:

To ensure compliance with company policies and Lebanese Labour Law, employees must provide proper documentation for all sick leave requests exceeding three consecutive days. Documentation must include:

- A medical certificate issued by a licensed physician or healthcare provider, clearly stating the nature of the illness or injury and the recommended period of absence.
- If requested by the company, additional documentation, such as medical test results or specialists' reports, may be required.
- All documentation must be submitted to the HR department within five business days of the absence start date.

5. Exceptions and Special Circumstances:

The company recognizes that certain situations may require additional flexibility. The following exceptions apply:

- In cases of prolonged illness or chronic medical conditions, additional paid or unpaid sick leave may be granted at the discretion of management.
- Employees who are hospitalized or require long-term treatment may be eligible for extended leave arrangements under the company's Leave Without Pay policy.
- Sick leave taken for the care of an immediate family member (e.g., spouse, child, or parent) will be considered on a case-by-case basis and may be deducted from the employee's annual leave balance if approved.
- Employees who are unable to provide medical documentation due to exceptional circumstances must communicate this to the HR department as soon as possible for further guidance.

6. Abuse of Sick Leave Policy:

Sick leave is intended to support the recovery and well-being of employees. Abuse or misuse of this policy is strictly prohibited and may result in disciplinary action. Examples of abuse include:

- Submitting fraudulent or falsified medical certificates.
- Taking sick leave for reasons unrelated to health or well-being without prior approval.
- Excessive absenteeism without valid justification or documentation.

7. Independent Medical Evaluation:

The company reserves the right to request an independent medical evaluation in the following cases:

- Prolonged or frequent absences that raise concerns about the employee's ability to perform their duties.
- Situations where the validity of the medical documentation submitted by the employee is in question.
- Cases involving potential workplace-related injuries or illnesses.

The cost of the independent medical evaluation will be borne by the company, and the employee will be required to comply with the evaluation process.

8. Employee Responsibilities:

Employees are expected to:

- Notify their supervisor promptly in the event of illness or injury.
- Submit all required documentation in a timely manner.
- Avoid engaging in activities that may delay recovery or exacerbate their condition while on sick leave.
- Maintain open communication with their supervisor and the HR department regarding any updates on their health status or return-to-work plans.

9. Employer Responsibilities:

The company is committed to:

- Ensuring all employees are aware of their sick leave rights and responsibilities.
- Handling sick leave requests in a fair and consistent manner.
- Maintaining the confidentiality of employees' medical information, in compliance with applicable privacy laws.
- Providing reasonable accommodations for employees returning to work after a prolonged illness or injury.

10. Compliance and Disciplinary Measures:

To ensure compliance with this policy, the company will:

- Monitor sick leave usage and address any patterns of excessive or unexplained absenteeism.
- Conduct investigations in cases where fraudulent or falsified medical certificates are suspected.
- Apply disciplinary measures, up to and including termination, for employees found to be in violation of this policy.

11. Review and Amendments:

This policy is subject to periodic review to ensure adherence to Lebanese Labour Law and alignment with company objectives. Any amendments to the policy will be communicated to all employees in writing.

By adhering to this Sick Leave Policy, employees and management can work together to maintain a healthy and productive workplace while respecting the rights and obligations of all parties.